

FORTY-FOURTH
ANNUAL REPORT OF THE
BUREAU OF
AMERICAN ETHNOLOGY

TO THE SECRETARY OF THE
SMITHSONIAN INSTITUTION

1926-1927



UNITED STATES
GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE
WASHINGTON

1928

DOCUMENTS/MICROFORMS

JUL 01 1986

THOMAS COOPER LIBRARY
UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH CAROLINA

CONTENTS

REPORT OF THE CHIEF

	Page
Systematic researches.....	2
Special researches.....	10
Editorial work and publications.....	15
Illustrations.....	16
Library.....	17
Collections.....	17
Property.....	18
Miscellaneous.....	18

ACCOMPANYING PAPERS

Exploration of the Burton Mound at Santa Barbara, California, by John P. Harrington.....	23
Social and religious beliefs and usages of the Chickasaw Indians, by John R. Swanton.....	169
Uses of plants by the Chippewa Indians, by Frances Densmore.....	275
Archeological investigations—II, by Gerard Fowke.....	399

CONTENTS

	Page
Introduction.....	31
History of Burton Mound.....	32
Earliest history.....	33
Mention of Synchia in the Relation of the Voyage of Cadillo, 1592.....	35
Mention in the diaries of the Portola expedition, 1769-1770.....	36
Mention in the Tent diary of the Anza expedition, 1776.....	38
Mention in the accounts of the founding of the presidio of Santa Barbara, 1782.....	39
Vancouver's account of his visit to Santa Barbara, 1792.....	40
Mention in the Gayarchan Report, 1793.....	42
Alfred Robinson describes a visit to Santa Barbara in 1829.....	43
Grant of title of the Burton Mound property.....	46
Ownership by the Mexican Government, James Davis, Joseph Hotel Company, and American Hotel Corporation.....	47
Later owners.....	49
M. Amador.....	50
Arthur.....	51
Mrs. Rebecca Trussell.....	52
Miss M. Foster.....	53
James M. Carter.....	54
Charles T. Hall.....	54
An early description of the Burton Mound.....	54
Excavation of the Burton Mound.....	56
Previous searching and relic hunting by others.....	58
Description of the mound.....	58
The springs of the Burton Mound.....	60
The grading of the Burton Mound.....	60
Excavated areas.....	61
The foundations of the adobe house.....	61
The old Burton well.....	62
Description of the artifacts.....	62
Objects of stone.....	63
Flattened bowls of sandstone.....	63
Bowls of sandstone with grooved rim.....	64
Hemlock.....	64
Hemlock mortars.....	65
Pebbles.....	66
Limestone dishes.....	67
Tray of sandstone.....	68

The next conveyance was by Isaac J. Sparks, transferring a lot 200 varas square, surrounding the house, enclosed by a fence, and on which a mill was erected. This deed was dated Feb. 6, 1840.

On Dec. 6th, 1851, the city of Santa Barbara, by deed . . . recognized the ownership of the entire tract to be in one Hinchman (that was an action closing all streets on the tract).

On Jan. 26th, 1875, the Sea Side Hotel Association was organized.

OWNERSHIP BY THE MEXICAN GOVERNMENT, JAMES BURKE, JOSEPH CHAPMAN

Of the ownership by the Mexican Government and by James Burke, better known as Don Santiago Burke, we have in the present progress of our studies only documentary information. The second individual owner was Joseph Chapman (otherwise Don José Chatman). He must have obtained some form of residence there, since Mr. William H. Manis, grandson of Joseph Chapman, says that he learned from his mother (Joseph Chapman's daughter) that she was born on the Burton Mound in a small building that afterwards became a wing of the massive adobe of later years.

The next traditional owner or occupant was Thomas Robins, who was later a grantee of the Hope Ranch. It is said to have been Robins who built the main part of the adobe house on the mound.

The identity of the next owner is still in doubt. According to Mrs. J. F. Freeman, of Santa Barbara, her husband's great grandfather, — Foxen, owned the place for a short period after Robins gave it up.

OWNERSHIP BY CAPT. GEORGE C. NIDEVER

Capt. George C. Nidever came into possession of the property in 1840 or 1841. Nidever came to Santa Barbara in 1834 from West Virginia, having taken eight years to cross the continent, hunting, trapping and fighting by turn. At Santa Barbara he followed otter hunting by profession. He was the first man to stock San Miguel Island. He was the principal in the rescue of the "lone woman" of San Nicolas Island. He married Sinforosa Sanchez in 1841. Slow of speech and movement, of unblushing integrity, and a dead shot, he was a terror of evildoers. He resided at the mound for some 10 years and added two outbuildings to the adobe house; one was used as a warehouse for furs, the other as a gristmill. It is said that Nidever made improvements in the grounds, setting out trees and gardens.

To the Bancroft Library of the University of California we are indebted for the following excerpts from a manuscript entitled "Life and Adventures of George Nidever, Recollections furnished by himself to E. F. Murray for the Bancroft Library, 1878." In this inter-

view Nidever tells of his purchase of the mound property from Joseph Chapman in 1840, and of his hiding out in the old adobe house on the mound at the time of the invasion of California by the Americans. He says:

I was born in 1802, Dec. 20, in Sullivan Co., East Tenn. My father, also named George, was a native of Penn.; I do not remember the town. . . .

In the fall of 1840 I bought what is now known as the Burton Mound property from Joseph Chapman, who had purchased it from the mission. It had formerly been used to store hides in by the Fathers.

OWNERSHIP BY A. F. HINCHMAN

In 1851 Captain Nidever sold the mound property to A. F. Hinchman, Santa Barbara attorney and a prominent citizen. Miss Stella G. Hinchman, daughter of A. F. Hinchman, has very kindly furnished interesting information and documents on the history of the mound at that period.

In a letter dated July 3, 1923, Miss Hinchman writes as follows:

Having read some articles printed in the Los Angeles papers which tell of the work you are doing in Santa Barbara, I am taking the liberty of writing to you because I am interested in your discoveries, as my father sold the property to Mr. Lewis T. Burton, and it was then called "La Playa" (The Beach). In 1849 my father, Augustus F. Hinchman, in company with his classmate, Mr. Edward Sherman Hoar, of Massachusetts, a brother of the late Judge Hoar, both having graduated from Harvard and also from the Harvard Law School, decided to go to California, but on the trip my father contracted the Panama fever, and when they arrived in San Francisco he was too ill to go to the gold fields, and his doctor advised him to go south and camp until he regained his health. Mr. Hoar and my father went to Santa Barbara expecting to stay a few weeks, but they were so delighted with the place that they decided to remain and open a law office.

After they acquired a practice my father decided to have a home and bought Burton Mound from Mr. George C. Nidever, with the knowledge that it had been an Indian burial ground. The property originally belonged to the church, the church sold it to Mr. Joseph Chapman, Mr. Chapman sold it to Mr. Nidever, and Mr. Nidever to my father.

As soon as my father acquired the property, he started to beautify the place, laying out a garden and planting trees. As soon as they commenced to work, they unearthed mortars, pestles, skulls and bones.

About that time a member of the Smithsonian Institution was in California and my father entertained him and gave him many relics for the Smithsonian. The only thing my father retained was a pipe, and the skulls and bones were cremated. I think that if you look at the records of the Smithsonian of the years 1851 and 1853, you will get some information about them. My brother visited the Smithsonian Institution some years ago and was told that they had been placed with the other Indian relics, but he did not locate them.

In a letter dated December 6, 1851, Mr. Hinchman says:

One of the first things that strikes the eye of a stranger, who comes to Santa Barbara, is a little hill which breaks the uniformity of the plain, rising perhaps 20 feet above the general level of the surrounding land. The hill has a gradual slope on all sides to its base and covers about 15 acres. All the